ANZHENG LI

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of Delaware, Newark, DE, May 2027 (expected)

Dissertation: Essays in Applied Microeconomics: Education, Health Care Markets, and Policy Evaluation.

Dissertation committee: Jeremy Tobacman (Chair), Valerie Michelman, Maria Rosales-Rueda, Kenneth A. Shores, and Tom Eisenberg.

M.S., Economics, Northeastern University, Boston, MA, 2022

B.S., Mathematics, Hefei University of Technology, Hefei, China, 2020

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Economics of Education, Health Economics, Industrial Organization, Applied Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

"Dynamic Treatment Effects in Education." [Paper] Job Market Paper.

"Higher Education or Just Higher? The Unintended Effects of Recreational Marijuana Legalization." [Paper]

"New Sites, New Services: Evidence from a Randomized Dialysis Payment Reform." [Paper]

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Pharmacy Closures and the Geography of Medication Access."

"When Does AI Pay? Capabilities, Costs, and Occupational Adoption."

"Teacher Shortages: Staffing Responses and Consequences for Student Achievement."

PRESENTATIONS

American Economic Association / ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, 2027 (scheduled).

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston, TX, 2026 (scheduled).

APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA, 2026 (scheduled).

Brown Bag Lunch, University of Delaware, 2025, 2026.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Student Travel Grant, University of Delaware, 2026.

Teaching Fellowship (stipend and tuition remission), University of Delaware, 2022-2026.

Summer Research Fellowship, University of Delaware, Summer 2025.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Jianfei Cao, Northeastern University, Summer 2022.

Applied topic modeling and clustering to text data for economic research.

Intern, China Securities Co., Ltd., November-December 2019.

Collected and organized client financial data and prepared information for proposals.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Delaware

Intermediate Microeconomics, Fall 2026 (Teaching Assistant).

Intermediate Macroeconomics, Fall 2026 (Teaching Assistant).

Introduction to Macroeconomics, Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026 (Teaching Assistant; discussion sections).

Introduction to Microeconomics, Spring 2025 (Teaching Assistant; discussion sections).

Microeconomic Theory II (Ph.D.), Spring 2024 (Teaching Assistant; recitations).

Fundamentals of Business Analytics, Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023 (Teaching Assistant).

COMPUTER SKILLS

Stata, R, Python, SQL, LaTeX.

REFERENCES

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Dynamic Treatment Effects in Education [Paper] (Job Market Paper)

Lifetime welfare calculations often rely on policy effects on educational attainment measured in a study's final observation window - for example, effects on college completion by age 25. But a higher completion rate by age 25 could reflect more people eventually graduating, earlier graduation among those who would have graduated anyway, or both. This paper develops a framework to assess the welfare implications of this uncertainty. I document the timing information in existing studies and model possible continuations of observed education effects. Two deterministic simulations show how different education paths can match the same observed effect yet imply different lifetime earnings values, and how additional observations can narrow this range. I apply the framework to 38 policy calculations to reconstruct ranges for the marginal value of public funds (MVPF) and propose an ordering rule based on these ranges. Under the specified path and valuation assumptions, the same education evidence can support conflicting welfare judgments even when the estimated effects are treated as known. My contribution is a framework for assessing the robustness of welfare comparisons to unobserved education paths and quantifying how estimates from each additional observation window can narrow uncertainty.

Higher Education or Just Higher? The Unintended Effects of Recreational Marijuana Legalization [Paper]

This paper examines the effects of recreational marijuana legalization (RML) on educational attainment in the United States. Exploiting variation from the staggered adoption of RML across states, I find that RML reduces the probability of earning a bachelor's degree within four, five, and six years by 3.8%, 2.0%, and 3.1%, respectively, relative to pre-treatment means. In addition, RML lowers the three-year graduation rate at two-year colleges by 6.0% relative to the pre-treatment mean. These effects suggest that RML not only delays degree completion but may also lower educational attainment in the longer run. I further find that RML reduces grade point average (GPA) among currently enrolled college students ages 18-24 and study time among individuals in the same age range. Increases in marijuana-use frequency and other substance use among college-age individuals are plausible mechanisms, although the data do not establish their contribution to the educational effects. These findings highlight the potential educational costs of marijuana legalization alongside the documented benefits identified in prior research.

New Sites, New Services: Evidence from a Randomized Dialysis Payment Reform [Paper]

I use the geographic randomization of Medicare's End-Stage Renal Disease Treatment Choices (ETC) Model to study how payment incentives shape the services that new facilities supply after entry. Linking facility entry histories to annual cost reports, I follow fixed entry cohorts and incumbents through 2024 and compare their contributions with covered-market supply. Statistically significant increases in home dialysis-providing facilities and Medicare home treatments are concentrated among early entrants. The first payment-period cohort contributes an additional 0.125 providing facilities and 183.01 Medicare home-treatment equivalents per hospital referral region on average, with positive treatment responses continuing through follow-up. A similar pattern is not evident among incumbents or across the covered market. For the first payment-period cohort, an accounting decomposition assigns most of the supply increase to entrant numbers, with a smaller contribution from service per entrant. Higher reported training and administrative staffing accompany this expansion. Supplementary market estimates show lower long-term catheter use and higher fistula use; effects on mortality, hospitalization, and geographic access remain imprecisely estimated. These findings suggest that new facilities can be a margin of recorded supply adjustment to payment reform, while net market expansion and broader welfare gains remain uncertain.